

ENGLISH

PAPER 1

STUDENT STUDY GUIDE

Everything explained in plain language · Based on past papers



Meet Lex — Your English Study Mentor

Lex, short for Lexicon, comes from the Latin meaning 'a vocabulary or collection of words' — so language is literally her thing. She helps you understand how words work, not just memorise them. Whether it's comprehension, summary, or grammar, Lex keeps it clear and sharp. Think of her as your voice, just more polished — helping you write smarter, not longer.

WHAT'S INSIDE

- P1** What the Paper Looks Like
- P2** The 5 Skills That Give You the Most Marks
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What Does the Paper Look Like?

English Paper 1 follows a highly predictable structure every year. The sections stay the same, the question styles repeat, and the same core skills are tested again and again. If you prepare correctly, there should be no surprises.

- Total marks: 70 | Time: 2 hours 30 minutes
- Answer ALL questions in ALL THREE sections
- Section A: Comprehension (30 marks)
- Section B: Summary (10 marks)
- Section C: Language Structures and Conventions (30 marks)

● **Tip:** 70 marks in 2.5 hours = just over 1.7 minutes per mark. Keep moving. Do not overinvest in one difficult question — the paper rewards breadth and method.

Section	What it Tests	Marks	Difficulty
A	Reading, inference, tone, evaluation	30	Medium
B	Summarising in own words	10	Medium
C	Ads, cartoons, grammar, editing	30	Medium

Section A — Comprehension

You read two texts (usually an article and a cartoon or visual). Questions test your ability to extract information, infer meaning, identify tone and diction, evaluate the writer's purpose, and analyse visual elements. Always use evidence from the text in your answers.

Section B — Summary

You read a passage and summarise a specific aspect in your own words. The passage tells you exactly what to summarise. You earn marks for content points (7) and language (3). Your summary must not exceed 90 words and must read as a fluent paragraph.

Section C — Language Structures and Conventions

This section tests advertisements, posters, cartoons, and a range of grammar and editing tasks. It rewards students who know the technical terminology and can apply it with precision. Every sub-question tests a specific skill — read each one carefully before responding.

Suggested Timing

Section A: Comprehension	45–50 minutes
Section B: Summary	20–25 minutes
Section C: Language	35–40 minutes
Final check	5 minutes



The 5 Skills That Give You the Most Marks

These five skills appear repeatedly across every past paper and offer the highest return. Master them and you can walk into the exam knowing exactly where marks come from.

1 Inference Questions

Section A — appears in every paper

Why it matters: Inference is the ability to read between the lines. The answer is not stated directly — you must use clues in the text to reach a logical conclusion.

What you must know:

- The difference between 'literal' and 'inferential' questions
- Command words: suggest, infer, explain, discuss, comment
- How to use evidence to justify your inference
- How to answer in your own words while quoting to support
- That inference marks require both the idea AND the evidence

Common question types: Inference, explain the meaning, suggest why, comment on

Quick-win strategy: Find a quote that hints at the answer. State the implied meaning in your own words. Then give the quote as proof. This method scores full marks every time.

2 Tone, Attitude and Purpose

Section A — appears in every paper

Why it matters: Tone questions test whether you can identify HOW the writer communicates — not just WHAT they say. Diction (word choice) is the key to unlocking tone.

What you must know:

- The difference between tone, attitude, and mood
- How specific word choices create specific tones
- Tone bank: critical, sarcastic, humorous, admiring, concerned, persuasive, cynical, dismissive, reflective, frustrated, urgent, ironic
- How to identify writer's purpose (to persuade, inform, entertain, critique)
- How to justify your tone identification with evidence from the text

Common question types: What is the tone? Comment on diction. What is the writer's purpose? How does word choice affect meaning?

Quick-win strategy: Name the tone. Quote one word or phrase that creates it. Explain WHY that word creates that tone. Three steps, full marks.

3 Summary Writing

Section B — 10 marks every single paper



Why it matters: Summary is one of the most predictable tasks in the paper. The question always tells you exactly what to summarise. Scan for the right points, paraphrase them, and write one fluent paragraph.

What you must know:

- How to read the summary instruction carefully — it tells you exactly what to find
- How to scan the passage for content points quickly
- Difference between main ideas and supporting detail (ignore examples, anecdotes)
- How to paraphrase correctly — same idea, different words
- How to stay under 90 words while fitting 7 content points
- How the 3 language marks are awarded (fluency, own words, accuracy)

Common question types: 7 content points + 3 language marks. Scan, identify, paraphrase, combine where possible.

Quick-win strategy: Read the instruction first. Scan for 7–8 distinct points. Write in one paragraph. Never copy sentences from the text. Check your word count.

4 Visual Literacy — Advertisements and Cartoons Section C — appears every year

Why it matters: Visual texts require you to analyse image, text, layout, and technique together. Advertisements use persuasion. Cartoons use humour, exaggeration, and symbolism.

What you must know:

- Advertisements: slogan, headline, target audience, persuasive techniques, image-text relationship
- Cartoons: exaggeration, irony, symbolism, body language, facial expression, caption
- How to identify and explain: font size and style, colour use, layout, white space
- Persuasive techniques: bandwagon, emotional appeal, statistics, direct address
- That every visual element has a purpose — nothing is accidental

Common question types: Target audience, slogan analysis, image effect, persuasive technique, tone of advertisement, message of cartoon

Quick-win strategy: For advertisements: identify the technique, name it, explain its effect on the audience. For cartoons: describe → explain message → explain symbolism. Never just describe — always interpret.

5 Grammar, Editing and Transformations Section C — 18 marks



Why it matters: Grammar questions are the most structured part of the paper. Every question tests a specific rule. Know the rules and you collect marks efficiently.

What you must know:

- Parts of speech: noun, verb, adjective, adverb, pronoun, preposition, conjunction
- Prefixes and suffixes: ir-, un-, dis-, -ful, -less, -tion
- Synonyms and antonyms
- Direct to indirect speech (reported speech) — verb tense, pronoun, time changes
- Sentence transformation — active/passive, degrees of comparison, positive/negative
- Redundancy: identifying and removing unnecessary repetition
- Ambiguity: identifying and rewriting sentences with two possible meanings
- Common errors: their/there/they're, its/it's, who/whom

Common question types: Parts of speech, prefix/suffix, synonym, antonym, redundancy, ambiguity, sentence transformation, direct/indirect speech

Quick-win strategy: Read the instruction exactly. The question tells you the rule to apply. Rewrite only what is asked. Check your grammar before moving on.



How to Solve Each Question Type

Follow these steps exactly. They work every time. Each method includes worked examples at three levels — Easy, Standard, and Hard.

METHOD 1

Literal and Inference Comprehension

Step 1 — Read the command word carefully

The command word tells you exactly what the examiner wants. 'Quote' = exact words from the text. 'Explain' = give reasons. 'Suggest' = infer from clues. 'Comment' = analyse and evaluate. Identify the command word before you write a single word.

Step 2 — Locate the relevant section

The question usually tells you which paragraph to look in. Go directly there. Do not read the whole text again for every question — work efficiently.

Step 3 — Answer directly, then support

State your answer first. Then quote or paraphrase evidence from the text to prove it. The structure is: Answer → Evidence → Explanation. Never give evidence without linking it back to your answer.

Step 4 — Use your own words unless asked to quote

If the question says 'in your own words', copying the text earns zero. Paraphrase: same idea, different words. If it says 'quote', use quotation marks and copy exactly.

● **Tip:** Command words carry marks. 'Explain' means give a reason. 'Identify' means name it. 'Discuss' means analyse from more than one angle. Read carefully — the wrong approach loses all the marks.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Easy

Question: Refer to paragraph 2. Explain what the word 'sobering' suggests about the writer's attitude toward social media. (2)

Step 1: Command word = 'explain'. I need to give a reason, not just define the word.

Step 2: Find paragraph 2 — the writer presents statistics about anxiety and sleep disorders.

Step 3: Answer — 'Sobering' suggests the writer finds these statistics alarming and serious, rather than incidental. (1)

Step 4: Evidence — The word implies the data should make the reader more serious and clear-headed, indicating the writer's concerned and critical attitude. (1)

✓ 2/2 — Answer + explanation of effect + attitude all present.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Standard



Question: Refer to paragraph 3. In your own words, explain why teenagers are particularly vulnerable to social media addiction. (3)

Step 1: 'Explain in your own words' — do not copy the text.

Step 2: Find paragraph 3 — it discusses dopamine and the prefrontal cortex.

Step 3: Answer — Because the part of the brain that controls long-term thinking and impulse management (the prefrontal cortex) is still developing in teenagers, they are more easily caught in the cycle of seeking immediate rewards from likes and comments. (3)

✓ 3/3 — Reason clearly explained in own words with specific reference to the text's idea.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Hard

Question: Is the writer objective in this article? Motivate your answer by referring to the text. (3)

Step 1: 'Motivate' = give reasons with evidence. This is an evaluative question.

Step 2: Consider both sides — does the writer acknowledge opposing views?

Step 3: Not fully objective. The writer's language reveals concern and urgency: 'the current situation is unsustainable' (1). While paragraph 6 acknowledges benefits of social media, defenders are given one paragraph while criticism dominates the text (1). The conclusion calls for accountability, revealing the writer's clear position (1).

✓ 3/3 — Clear judgement + evidence + explanation of how it reveals the writer's stance.

✓ Try It Yourself

Refer to paragraph 4. What does Dr Khumalo mean when she says young people compare their 'unfiltered selves to everyone else's highlight reel'? Use your own words. (2)

Answer: Young people measure their real, imperfect daily lives against the carefully chosen best moments that others post online — an unfair comparison that makes their own lives seem inferior.

METHOD 2

Tone, Attitude, Diction and Writer's Purpose

Step 1 — Identify the dominant feeling in the writing

Ask: does this writing feel critical, warm, alarming, sarcastic, hopeful? Read a few lines and name the overall feeling before looking for individual words.

Step 2 — Find the specific words that create that feeling

Diction (word choice) is the evidence for tone. Look for strong adjectives, verbs with emotional weight, and unexpected comparisons. The examiner wants you to explain why a specific word creates a specific effect.

Step 3 — Name the tone precisely

Do not say 'sad' when you mean 'despairing'. Do not say 'happy' when you mean 'optimistic'. Precise tone words earn marks. Use this tone bank: critical, sarcastic, humorous, admiring, concerned, persuasive, cynical, dismissive, reflective, frustrated, urgent, ironic, measured, alarmed.

Step 4 — Justify with a quotation

Every tone identification must be supported with a quote. State the tone → quote the word or phrase → explain the connection. Without the justification, you earn zero marks for tone questions.



● **Tip:** The examiner is not testing whether you feel the same tone as everyone else. They are testing whether you can NAME the tone accurately and JUSTIFY it with language evidence. One word, correctly identified and explained, is worth full marks.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Easy

Question: Identify the tone of the article and justify your answer with a quotation from the text. (2)

Step 1: The writing feels serious and alarming — it presents statistics and builds urgency.

Step 2 & 3: Tone = concerned and urgent.

Step 4: Justified by: 'the current situation is unsustainable' — the word 'unsustainable' creates urgency and alarm, suggesting the writer believes immediate action is needed.

✓ 2/2 — **Tone named + quote + effect explained.**

WORKED EXAMPLE

Standard

Question: Comment on the effect of the word 'colonised' in paragraph 1. (2)

Step 1: 'Colonised' is not a neutral word — it carries historical meaning linked to conquest and control.

Step 2: The writer could have said 'taken over' or 'filled' but chose 'colonised' deliberately.

Step 3: Effect — 'Colonised' implies that smartphones have invaded and dominated young people's daily routines without their full awareness or consent, much like historical colonisation. (1) This word choice suggests the writer views social media's influence as deeply problematic and controlling, not merely inconvenient. (1)

✓ 2/2 — **Effect of specific word choice + link to writer's critical tone.**

WORKED EXAMPLE

Hard

Question: Discuss the tone of the article as a whole. Identify at least TWO tone words and justify your choices with evidence from the text. (3)

Step 1: Read across the whole article — sustained tone, not just one paragraph.

Step 2–4: The tone is concerned and critical. (1) 'Concerned' is supported by: 'The statistics are sobering' — the writer presents alarming data to prompt the reader to take the issue seriously. (1) 'Critical' is supported by: 'architecturally designed to exploit the human need for social validation' — 'exploit' reveals the writer's disapproval of deliberate corporate manipulation. (1)

✓ 3/3 — **Two tones named, two quotes given, effects of both explained.**

✓ Try It Yourself

Identify the writer's purpose in writing this article. Justify your answer with ONE quotation. (2)

Answer: The writer's purpose is to persuade readers — especially parents, educators, and policymakers — that social media's design poses serious risks to young people's mental health. Evidence: 'the platforms must be held accountable for the harm their design choices cause' — the call for accountability shows the writer wants to create change, not merely inform.



Step 1 — Read the instruction carefully

The summary question always tells you exactly what to summarise. Underline the key focus: 'what teenagers need' or 'the dangers of social media' or 'the effects of the policy'. Every point you include must address THIS specific focus — nothing else.

Step 2 — Scan the passage for content points

Read quickly and number each distinct point you find. Aim for 8–10 rough points — you will only use 7. Focus on main ideas, not examples or anecdotes. If the passage says 'for example' or 'such as', that is usually support for an already-stated point.

Step 3 — Paraphrase each point

Rewrite each point in your own words. Same idea, completely different sentence structure and vocabulary. If your summary sounds like the original text, you will lose language marks — and possibly all content marks for copied sentences.

Step 4 — Write one fluent paragraph

Combine your 7 points into a single flowing paragraph. Use connectives: furthermore, in addition, however, consequently. Do not use bullet points or headings. Read it aloud — if it sounds choppy, add connectives.

● **Tip:** Language marks: 3 = fluent paragraph, own words, within limit. 2 = mostly own words, minor issues. 1 = significant copying or over limit. Count your words before you stop writing.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Standard

Question: The passage explains what teenagers need from adults and the strengths that teenagers possess. Summarise these points in a single paragraph of 7–8 points. Do not exceed 90 words. (10)

Step 1: Focus = what teenagers need AND their unique strengths. Two categories.

Step 2: Content points from passage:

NEEDS: (1) meaningful connection (2) genuine challenge (3) trust from adults (4) space for honest conversation (5) freedom to fail and recover

STRENGTHS: (6) creative energy (7) moral sensitivity and justice (8) willingness to act on principle (9) ability to change the world

Model summary (84 words): Teenagers need meaningful connection and genuine challenge from the adults around them, as well as the belief that they are trusted. They benefit from honest conversation and the freedom to fail and recover. In terms of strengths, teenagers possess remarkable creative energy and a deep sense of justice. They are often willing to act on principle at personal cost — a quality that has historically enabled young people to bring about significant change.

✓ 7/7 content + 3/3 language — fluent, own words, under 90 words.

✓ Try It Yourself

Identify THREE summary mistakes to avoid.

Answer: (1) Copying sentences from the passage. (2) Writing more than 90 words. (3) Including examples or anecdotes instead of main ideas. (4) Writing in bullet points instead of a paragraph.



Step 1 — Identify the text type and its purpose

Advertisements want to persuade or sell. Posters want to inform or raise awareness. Cartoons want to comment or critique. Knowing the purpose helps you identify what every element is designed to do.

Step 2 — Analyse image and text together

In visual texts, image and text work as a team. The image creates emotion; the text anchors the meaning. Identify: what does the image show? What does the slogan/headline say? How do they reinforce each other?

Step 3 — Identify the target audience

Look for clues: vocabulary level, issue addressed, colours used, examples given, tone. Always give TWO pieces of evidence when asked to motivate your target audience answer.

Step 4 — Name and explain persuasive or visual techniques

Naming the technique alone earns only 1 mark. Explaining its effect earns the other mark. Always go: Technique name + 'This is effective because...' + specific effect on the audience.

● **Tip:** For cartoons: never just describe what you see. The examiner needs your interpretation. What does the exaggeration mean? What does the contrast show? What is being criticised? Description without analysis earns zero marks for message questions.

WORKED EXAMPLE**Standard**

Question: What is the message of the cartoon? How do the visual elements support this message? (3)

Cartoon: Two panels. Panel 1 shows a teenager with a phone, surrounded by colour, hearts, and '#PERFECT'. Panel 2 shows the same teenager in a grey room, phone showing '0 Likes'.

Step 1: Identify the message — social media creates a false, curated version of reality. (1)

Step 2: Visual evidence — Panel 1 uses bright colour and symbols of approval to represent the online world; Panel 2 uses grey and dullness to represent reality. (1)

Step 3: The contrast between panels and the irony of '#PERFECT' create the message that the gap between online performance and real life is extreme and harmful. (1)

✓ **3/3 — Message stated, two visual elements explained, irony identified.**

WORKED EXAMPLE**Hard**

Question: Identify ONE persuasive technique in the advertisement. Quote from the text and explain its effect on the target audience. (2)

Technique: Tricolon (rule of three) — three short parallel imperatives.

Quote: 'Put it down. Look up. Live.'

Effect: The three-part structure creates a memorable, punchy rhythm that is easy to remember. The final word 'Live' implies that putting down your phone is equivalent to truly living — making the slogan both motivational and emotionally powerful. (2)

✓ **2/2 — Technique named + quote + effect on audience explained.**



✓ **Try It Yourself**

Who is the target audience of the mental health awareness poster? Motivate your answer with TWO features. (2)

Answer: Target audience: South African teenagers and young adults. Motivation: (1) The statistic references 'South African teens', showing the audience is specifically local youth. (2) The 'What You Can Do' section uses simple, direct language and action steps aimed at younger readers who may not have access to professional help.



Step 1 — Read the question instruction exactly

Every grammar question tells you exactly what to do. 'Identify the part of speech' is different from 'give a synonym'. 'Rewrite in indirect speech' is different from 'change to passive voice'. Never answer a different question to the one asked.

Step 2 — Apply the rule you know

Grammar marks are rule-based. You either know the rule or you do not — but most rules are learnable. Know these cold: direct to indirect speech (tense, pronoun, time changes), active to passive, degrees of comparison, prefix/suffix meanings.

Step 3 — Check your answer

Read your rewritten sentence aloud. Does it make grammatical sense? Does it preserve the original meaning? Have you changed only what was asked? If yes, you have the mark.

Step 4 — Name, then explain for analytical questions

For questions about redundancy, ambiguity, or idiom: name what it is (one mark), then explain/correct it (second mark). Never try to collect both marks with one sentence.

● **Tip:** Direct to indirect speech: change present to past, 'I/we' to 'he/she/they', 'this/these' to 'that/those', remove inverted commas, add 'that' after the reporting verb. These four changes cover almost every reported speech question in Paper 1.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Easy

Question: Identify the parts of speech of (a) changed (b) simply (c) pressing. (3)

(a) changed = verb (past tense / past participle)

(b) simply = adverb (modifies the adjective/verb)

(c) pressing = adjective (describes the noun 'challenge')

✓ 3/3 — All three correctly identified.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Standard

Question: Rewrite in indirect speech beginning: "Dr Khumalo told her colleague that..." (2)

Original: "We need to teach young people how to use these tools wisely."

Step 1: Remove inverted commas. Add 'that' after 'colleague'.

Step 2: Change 'We' → 'they'; 'need' → 'needed'; 'these' → 'those'.

Answer: Dr Khumalo told her colleague that they needed to teach young people how to use those tools wisely.

✓ 2/2 — Pronoun, tense, demonstrative all changed correctly.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Hard



Question: The following sentence contains an ambiguity. Rewrite it to remove the ambiguity, choosing ONE meaning: 'Lerato watched the teacher correct the papers in her room.' (2)

Step 1: Identify the ambiguity — 'her room' could refer to Lerato's room OR the teacher's room. (1)

Step 2: Rewrite choosing ONE meaning:

Option 1: From her room, Lerato watched the teacher correct the papers.

Option 2: Lerato watched the teacher correct the papers in the teacher's room. (1)

✓ 2/2 — Ambiguity identified + unambiguous rewrite provided.

✓ **Try It Yourself**

Identify the redundancy in this sentence and rewrite it correctly: 'She repeated the question again because no one had answered.' (1)

Answer: 'Repeated' and 'again' are redundant — 'to repeat' already means to do something again.

Corrected: 'She repeated the question because no one had answered.'



Mistakes That Cost Students Marks

These are the most common reasons marks are dropped — even by students who know the content well.

1. Copying Instead of Answering in Own Words

✗ The student copies three full sentences from the passage when the question says 'in your own words'. This earns zero for language and risks zero for content.

✓ Paraphrase every time 'own words' appears. Same idea, completely different sentence. If your summary sounds like the original, rewrite it.

2. Choosing the Wrong Tone Word

✗ The student writes 'sad' or 'happy' when the question requires a precise academic tone word. Vague tone words earn nothing.

✓ Use precise tone vocabulary: concerned, cynical, sarcastic, urgent, dismissive, reflective. Then justify your choice with a quotation and an explanation of effect.

3. Giving Evidence Without Linking It

✗ The student quotes from the text but does not explain what the quote proves. The quote sits alone with no analysis.

✓ Always complete the circuit: Quote → explain what it reveals → link to the question. Evidence without explanation is like a claim without proof.

4. Too Many Words in the Summary

✗ The student writes 120 words for a 90-word summary. Language marks are deducted and content may not be credited for the overflow.

✓ Count your words as you write. Aim for 80–88 words. Combine two similar points into one sentence. Cut examples and anecdotes.

5. Describing the Cartoon Instead of Interpreting It

✗ The student writes 'The cartoon shows a person on a phone in a colourful scene.' This describes what is visible — it does not answer a message question.

✓ Message questions require interpretation: what does the image mean? what is the cartoonist criticising? what does the contrast represent? Describe, then explain the significance.

6. Naming a Literary or Language Device Without Explaining Its Effect

✗ The student writes 'The writer uses a metaphor.' This is 1 mark. The effect is the second mark — and it is always asked.

✓ Name the device, then explain its effect on the reader/audience. 'The writer uses a metaphor [1] which makes the abstract idea of digital addiction feel tangible and threatening to the reader [1].'



7. Careless Grammar Errors in Rewrites

✗ The student changes 'We need' to 'They needs' in a reported speech answer, or writes 'more better' in a degree of comparison.

✓ Read your rewritten sentence aloud after writing it. Grammar errors in transformation questions cost the entire mark for that rewrite.

8. Running Out of Time Before Section C

✗ The student spends 55 minutes on Section A and only 15 minutes on Section C — which carries 30 marks.

✓ Time your sections strictly. Section A = 45 min, Section B = 25 min, Section C = 40 min. Move on if you are stuck. Come back.



PART 5

Your 14-Day Study Plan

Follow this plan day by day. Each block builds skill and confidence. Do not skip ahead — the skills compound.

Days 1–3	Comprehension — Inference and Tone	30 marks available
→ Learn the difference between literal, inferential, and evaluative questions → Practise finding the exact quote that supports an inference — 15 passages → Memorise the tone bank (10 words): concerned, sarcastic, humorous, admiring, cynical, persuasive, dismissive, reflective, frustrated, urgent → Practise: identify tone + quote + explain effect — 2 texts per day → Goal: any comprehension question answered with answer + evidence + explanation in the correct structure		
Days 4–5	Summary Writing	10 marks available
→ Practise scanning a passage in 3 minutes and numbering 8–10 content points → Practise paraphrasing each point in your own words — check against the original → Write 3 complete summaries (each under 90 words) from past paper passages → Count your words for each summary — adjust to stay in the 80–88 range → Goal: a fluent 7-point summary paragraph completed in under 20 minutes		
Days 6–7	Visual Literacy — Advertisements and Cartoons	Part of 30 marks
→ Learn 6 persuasive techniques: direct address, statistics, emotional appeal, bandwagon, repetition, tricolon → Practise: for each advertisement — identify technique, name it, explain effect on audience → Practise cartoon analysis: describe → message → symbolism → context → Analyse 2 advertisements and 2 cartoons per day from past papers → Goal: full marks on any advertisement or cartoon question — technique + effect + audience		
Days 8–10	Grammar, Editing and Transformations	18 marks available
→ Master direct to indirect speech — write the 4 rules on a card and memorise → Practise 10 reported speech transformations from past papers → Learn parts of speech thoroughly — write sentences using each in context → Practise prefixes: ir-, un-, dis-, im-; suffixes: -ful, -less, -tion, -ness → Practise ambiguity questions: identify the two meanings, rewrite for one meaning → Goal: full marks on any grammar subsection — read the instruction, apply the rule, check the answer		
Days 11–12	Full Comprehension Past Papers (timed)	30 marks each



- Do one complete Section A from a past paper under timed conditions (45 min)
- Mark your own answers using the memorandum — circle every mark lost
- Write the reason for each mark lost — wrong tone word? no evidence? copied?
- Redo every lost-mark question correctly before moving on
- Goal: Section A completed in 45 minutes with 80% accuracy or better

Day 13	Full Paper Simulation	Exam conditions
→ Print the most recent past paper (2025 or 2024) → Set a 2.5-hour timer. Silence your phone. No notes. → Complete all three sections under timed conditions → Mark your work. Calculate your score out of 70. → Write exactly 3 things you lost marks on — revise those before the exam		

Day 14	Review and Consolidate	Final preparation
→ Re-read Part 2 of this guide — the 5 skills → Re-read Part 4 — the 8 mistakes. Check: have you fixed each one? → Do the 5-minute warm-up routine twice → Read your tone bank aloud. Write 3 sentences using different tones. → Remind yourself: the paper is predictable. The skills are learnable. You are ready.		

EVERY DAY — Daily 5-Minute Warm-Up

Do this before every study session. It keeps all skills sharp and builds speed over 14 days.

Daily Task	Why it matters
Identify 2 tone words from a short extract	Keeps your tone vocabulary active and precise
Answer 1 inference question from any text	Trains the answer → evidence → explanation circuit
Fix 2 grammar errors (from any source)	Grammar is mechanical — daily practice makes it automatic
Analyse 1 visual (advertisement or cartoon)	Visual literacy needs consistent practice to become instinctive
Rewrite 1 sentence in your own words	Summary and paraphrasing are learnable skills — daily repetition builds speed



You can do this. The paper is predictable. The skills are learnable.

Master the five core methods, avoid the common mistakes, and follow the 14-day plan. One clear step at a time. That is how marks are built — not through panic, not through guessing, but through smart practice of the right skills. You are more prepared than you think.

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ENGLISH HOME LANGUAGE

PAPER 1

PREDICTIVE QUESTION PAPER · 2026

Marks: 70

Time: 2 hours 30 minutes

Grade: 12 NSC

INSTRUCTIONS AND INFORMATION

1. This question paper consists of THREE sections: SECTION A (Comprehension), SECTION B (Summary), and SECTION C (Language Structures and Conventions).
2. Answer ALL questions in ALL THREE sections.
3. Read ALL the questions carefully.
4. Number your answers exactly as the questions are numbered.
5. Leave a line between answers.
6. Use your own words as far as possible. Do NOT copy chunks of text from the sources.
7. Start SECTION B and SECTION C on new pages.
8. Write neatly and legibly.

STRUCTURE OF THIS PAPER

Section	Content	Marks
Section A	Comprehension: Text A (Article) + Text B (Cartoon)	30
Section B	Summary	10
Section C	Language Structures and Conventions: Q3 Advertisement Q4 Poster Q5 Editing & Grammar	30
TOTAL		70

Note: This is a predictive paper prepared by RubyAI Tutor based on NSC exam pattern analysis from 2021–2025. It is intended for examination preparation only.

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Study TEXT A and TEXT B below, then answer the questions that follow. Use the texts AND your own knowledge in your answers.

TEXT A

The Price of the Perfect Post [Article]

Adapted from an article in the Sunday Times Youth Edition, 2025

Every morning, seventeen-year-old Thandi wakes up to forty-seven notifications before she has spoken a single word to any member of her family. She is not unusual. Across South Africa — from the townships of Soweto to the suburbs of Cape Town — smartphones have quietly colonised the first and last moments of young people's days.

The statistics are sobering. According to the South African Depression and Anxiety Group (SADAG), more than 73% of South African teenagers who use social media for over five hours a day report symptoms of anxiety. Sleep disorders among the 13–18 age group have risen by 40% over the past decade — a period that coincides almost perfectly with the widespread adoption of smartphones.

Yet the problem is more subtle than simple addiction. Social media platforms are not merely time-consuming; they are architecturally designed to exploit the human need for social validation. Every 'like', every comment, every share triggers a small release of dopamine — the same neurochemical activated by gambling or sugar. Teenagers, whose prefrontal cortices are still developing, are especially vulnerable to these feedback loops.

Dr Naledi Khumalo, a child psychologist practising in Johannesburg, argues that the danger lies not in the technology itself, but in the curated reality it presents. 'Young people are comparing their unfiltered selves to everyone else's highlight reel,' she explains.

This gap between online performance and offline reality creates what psychologists call 'social comparison injury' — a persistent sense of inadequacy fuelled by impossible standards. In a society already burdened by economic inequality, racial tension, and high rates of unemployment, this added psychological pressure falls disproportionately on young South Africans.

Defenders of social media argue that it provides communities for marginalised youth. These are legitimate benefits. But critics respond that the same platforms which offer community also commodify vulnerability, turning personal pain into content and human connection into currency.

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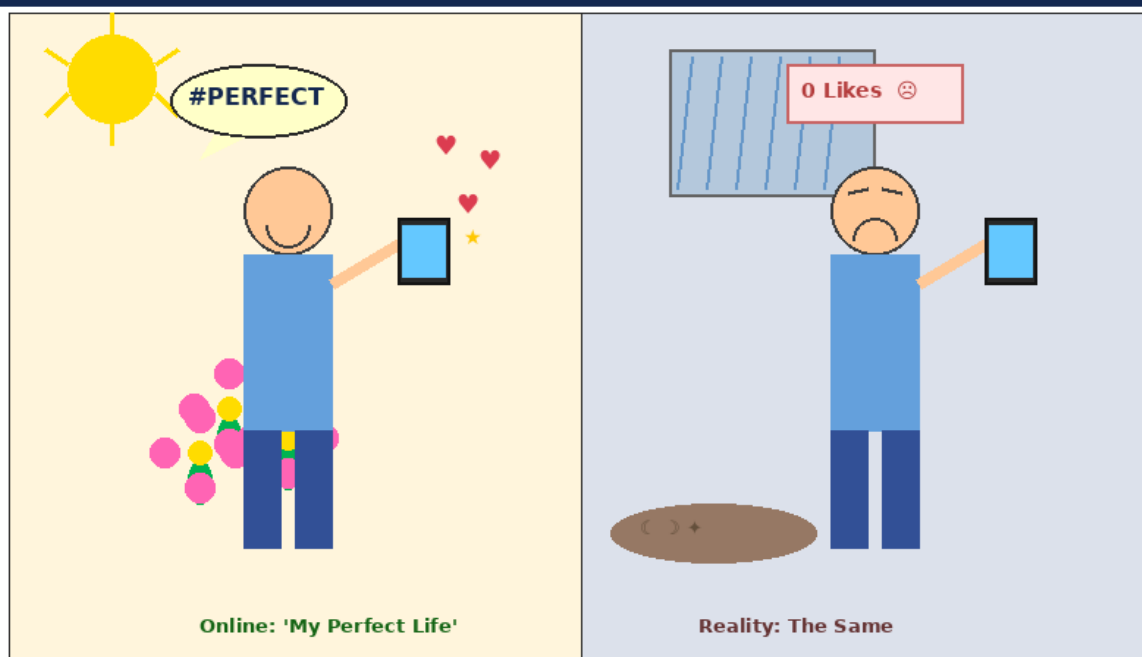
Note: This source is adapted for examination purposes.

TEXT B

Cartoon: 'The Filtered Life' (Visual Text)

Cartoon by Sipho Nkosi, adapted from Mail & Guardian, 2025

SOURCE B — Cartoon: 'The Filtered Life' (2025)



[Adapted from a South African editorial cartoon, 'The Filtered Life', 2025]

[Cartoon: 'The Filtered Life', adapted from Mail & Guardian, 2025]

QUESTIONS ON TEXT A

- 1.1 Refer to **paragraph 1**. Identify the *setting* and the *central concern* introduced by the writer. Use your own words. (2)
- 1.2 Refer to **paragraph 2**. Comment on the effect of the word '**sobering**'. What does this word choice reveal about the writer's attitude? (2)
- 1.3 Refer to **paragraph 3**. In your own words, explain how social media platforms exploit human psychology. Why are teenagers particularly at risk? (3)
- 1.4 Refer to **paragraph 4**. Explain what Dr Khumalo means by '*comparing their unfiltered selves to everyone else's highlight reel*'. Use your own words. (3)
- 1.5 Refer to **paragraph 5**. What is 'social comparison injury'? Discuss how the writer suggests this condition is made worse by South Africa's specific social context. (3)
- 1.6 Refer to **paragraphs 6 and 7**. The writer acknowledges benefits of social media before returning to criticism. Is this approach effective? Critically discuss, supporting your answer with evidence. (4)
- 1.7 Discuss the **tone** of the article as a whole. Identify at least TWO tone words and justify your choices with evidence from the text. (3)

- 1.8 Is the writer **objective** in this article? Motivate your answer by referring to the text. (3)

QUESTIONS ON TEXT B

- 2.1 Describe what is happening in **Panel 1** (left) of the cartoon. Identify at least TWO visual details. (2)
- 2.2 Explain the **humour** in the cartoon. How does the contrast between the two panels create a comic or ironic effect? (2)
- 2.3 What is the **message** of the cartoon? How do the visual elements support this message? (3)

QUESTIONS ON BOTH TEXTS

- 3.1 Both Text A and Text B address the impact of social media on young people. Identify ONE way in which they **agree** and ONE way their approaches **differ**. Quote evidence from **both texts**. (4)

Section A marks summary: 1.1 (2) + 1.2 (2) + 1.3 (3) + 1.4 (3) + 1.5 (3) + 1.6 (4) + 1.7 (3) + 1.8 (3) + 2.1 (2) + 2.2 (2) + 2.3 (3) + 3.1 (4) = 34 SECTION A TOTAL: 30

Read the passage below carefully and then answer the question that follows.

SUMMARY PASSAGE

Understanding the Teenage Brain

Adapted from an article in Parenting Today SA, 2025

Adolescence is one of the most significant — and frequently misunderstood — stages of human development. Adults who dismiss teenage behaviour as mere moodiness often fail to recognise the neurological reality: the teenage brain is a work in progress.

This biological reality has several practical consequences. Teenagers genuinely find it more difficult than adults to foresee the consequences of risky behaviour — not because they are irresponsible by nature, but because the brain structures that enable such foresight are still under construction.

Yet the teenage years are also a period of remarkable creative energy, moral sensitivity, and appetite for justice. Young people are often the first to identify social hypocrisy, to demand change, and to act on principle.

What teenagers need most, research suggests, is not stricter control or more protection, but meaningful connection, genuine challenge, and the belief that they are trusted. Schools and families that allow failure and recovery produce the most resilient, empathetic, and capable adults.

Understanding teenagers, then, is not about excusing bad behaviour or lowering expectations. It is about recognising who they really are: complex, contradictory, brilliant, and deeply human.

Note: This source is adapted for examination purposes.

QUESTION

- 4.1** The passage above identifies **what teenagers need from the adults around them** and **the unique strengths teenagers possess**. Summarise these points in a **single fluent paragraph of 7–8 points**. Your summary must not exceed **90 words**. Write in full sentences and use **your own words** as far as possible. (10)

NOTE: Marks will be awarded as follows:

- Content: 7 marks (one mark per valid, unique point)
- Language: 3 marks (accuracy, fluency, own words)

Section B marks summary: 4.1 (10) = SECTION B TOTAL: 10

QUESTION 5 — ADVERTISEMENT

Study the advertisement below carefully and then answer the questions that follow.

MINDFUL SA
South African Mental Wellness Initiative
www.mindfulsa.co.za

YOUR SCREEN IS NOT YOUR LIFE.

South African youth spend an average of 6 hours per day on screens.

Studies show that excessive screen time is linked to increased anxiety, depression, and reduced academic performance in teenagers. Every notification pulls you further from the people who matter most — your family, your friends, your community.

6hrs
average daily screen time

73%
report feeling anxious without phone

2x
more likely to feel lonely

"Put it down. Look up. Live."

JOIN THE DIGITAL DETOX CHALLENGE

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[Adapted from a South African public health advertisement, 2025]

[Adapted from a South African public health advertisement, 2025]

- 5.1 What does the headline '**YOUR SCREEN IS NOT YOUR LIFE**' mean in the context of this advertisement? Explain fully. (2)
- 5.2 Discuss how the visual choice of showing a phone with a cross through it effectively communicates the message of the advertisement. (2)
- 5.3 Identify and explain ONE **persuasive technique** used in the body text. Quote from the advertisement to support your answer. (2)
- 5.4 Comment on the **effect of the font/text style** used in the advertisement. (2)

- 5.5 Who is the **target audience**? Motivate your answer with reference to at least TWO features. (2)
- 5.6 Consider the slogan '**Put it down. Look up. Live.**' Explain why this slogan is effective. (2)

Section 5 Sub-total: (12)

QUESTION 6 — VISUAL TEXT / POSTER

Study the poster below carefully and then answer the questions that follow.



[Adapted from a South African mental health awareness poster, 2026]

- 6.1 What is the **purpose** of this poster? Identify at least TWO features that reveal this purpose. (2)
- 6.2 Refer to the **dominant image** (the brain and the phone). Explain what this image communicates and how it supports the message. (2)
- 6.3 Comment on the use of **colour** in the poster. How does the colour scheme contribute to the overall impact? (2)
- 6.4 Identify ONE **fact** and ONE **opinion** in the poster. Quote evidence for each. (2)

Section 6 Sub-total: (8)

QUESTION 7 — LANGUAGE STRUCTURES AND EDITING

Answer ALL the questions in this section.

EDITING PASSAGE

Read carefully and answer the questions below.

Social media have [A] changed the way young people communicate in South Africa. Many teenagers spend more time scrolling through they're [B] feeds than speaking to friends or family in person. The problem, however, is not simply that young people are lazy or irresponsible [C]; it is that the platforms are designed to be addictive. Acknowledging these dangers, most schools have nevertheless failed to include digital literacy in there [E] curriculums. Dr Khumalo, who has studied the issue extensively, told her colleague: "We need to teach young people how to use these tools wisely." [G] It is the most pressing challenge of our generation.

- 7.1 The word '**social**' is an adjective. Identify the **parts of speech** of: (a) *changed* (3)
(b) *simply* (c) *pressing*
- 7.2 Choose the correct option for error [A]: 'Social media have' OR 'Social media has'. Motivate your choice. (2)
- 7.3 Error [B] is a word-choice error. Identify the error and write the correct word. (1)
- 7.4 Rewrite the sentence containing error [C] beginning: '*Although young people are not simply lazy or irresponsible...*' Make only necessary changes. (2)
- 7.5 Identify the error at [E] and rewrite the relevant portion correctly. (1)
- 7.6 Rewrite [G] in **indirect (reported) speech**, beginning: '*Dr Khumalo told her colleague that...*' (2)
- 7.7 Give a **synonym** for '*pressing*' as used in the final sentence. (1)
- 7.8 Give the **antonym** of '*wisely*' as used in the passage. (1)
- 7.9 Add an appropriate **prefix** to '*responsible*' to change its meaning to the opposite. (1)
- 7.10 Identify and correct the **redundancy** in: '*She repeated the question again because no one had answered.*' (1)
- 7.11 Explain the meaning of the **idiom**: '*to burn the midnight oil*'. (1)
- 7.12 The following sentence contains an **ambiguity**. Rewrite it to remove the ambiguity, choosing ONE meaning: '*Lerato watched the teacher correct the papers in her room.*' (2)

Section C marks summary: Q5 (12) + Q6 (8) + Q7 (18) = SECTION C TOTAL: 38 Note: Internal mark adjustment applies; final credit = 30

END OF QUESTION PAPER

The sources below are referenced in the questions above. Source images are also provided as separate high-resolution PNG files.

TEXT A

The Price of the Perfect Post [Article]

Adapted from an article in the Sunday Times Youth Edition, 2025

Every morning, seventeen-year-old Thandi wakes up to forty-seven notifications before she has spoken a single word to any member of her family. She is not unusual. Across South Africa — from the townships of Soweto to the suburbs of Cape Town — smartphones have quietly colonised the first and last moments of young people's days.

The statistics are sobering. According to the South African Depression and Anxiety Group (SADAG), more than 73% of South African teenagers who use social media for over five hours a day report symptoms of anxiety. Sleep disorders among the 13–18 age group have risen by 40% over the past decade — a period that coincides almost perfectly with the widespread adoption of smartphones.

Yet the problem is more subtle than simple addiction. Social media platforms are not merely time-consuming; they are architecturally designed to exploit the human need for social validation. Every 'like', every comment, every share triggers a small release of dopamine — the same neurochemical activated by gambling or sugar. Teenagers, whose prefrontal cortices are still developing, are especially vulnerable to these feedback loops.

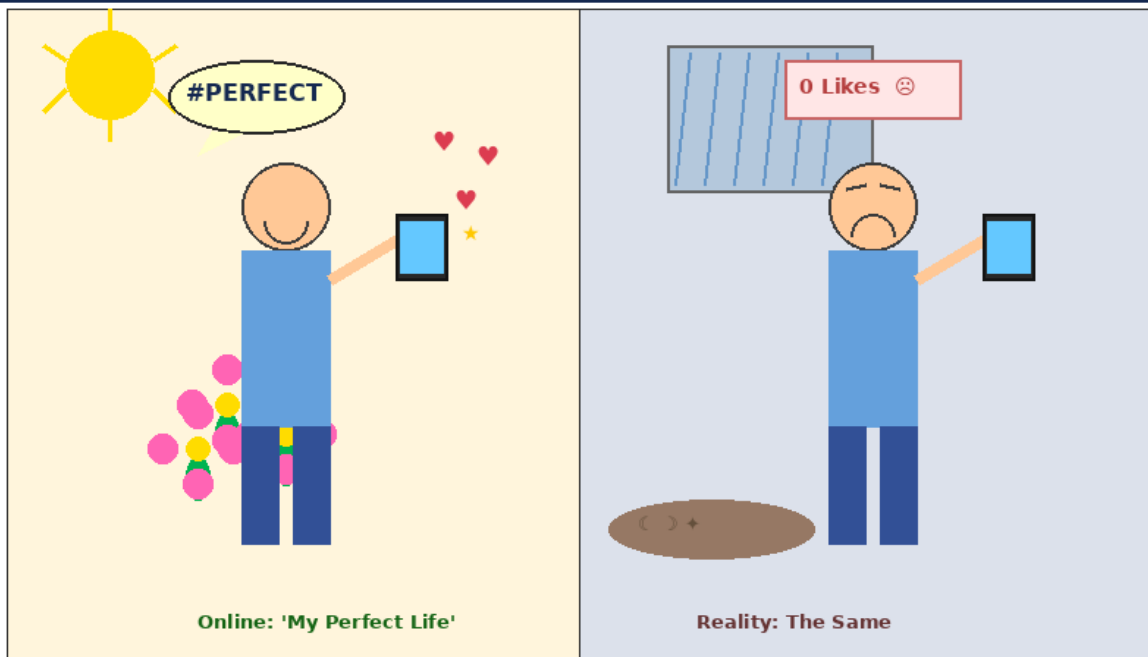
Dr Naledi Khumalo, a child psychologist practising in Johannesburg, argues that the danger lies not in the technology itself, but in the curated reality it presents. 'Young people are comparing their unfiltered selves to everyone else's highlight reel,' she explains.

This gap between online performance and offline reality creates what psychologists call 'social comparison injury' — a persistent sense of inadequacy fuelled by impossible standards. In a society already burdened by economic inequality, racial tension, and high rates of unemployment, this added psychological pressure falls disproportionately on young South Africans.

Defenders of social media argue that it provides communities for marginalised youth. These are legitimate benefits. But critics respond that the same platforms which offer community also commodify vulnerability, turning personal pain into content and human connection into currency.

What is certain is this: the current situation is unsustainable. Something must give — either the platforms must be held accountable for the harm their design choices cause, or South African schools, parents, and policymakers must equip young people with far stronger tools to navigate a world that has been engineered to keep them scrolling.

SOURCE B — Cartoon: 'The Filtered Life' (2025)



[Adapted from a South African editorial cartoon, 'The Filtered Life', 2025]

TEXT B: 'The Filtered Life' [Cartoon, Mail & Guardian, 2025]

**6 Hours Daily****Real Connection**

YOUR SCREEN IS NOT YOUR LIFE.

South African youth spend an average of 6 hours per day on screens.

Studies show that excessive screen time is linked to increased anxiety, depression, and reduced academic performance in teenagers. Every notification pulls you further from the people who matter most — your family, your friends, your community.

6hrs

average daily screen time

73%

report feeling anxious without phone

2x

more likely to feel lonely

"Put it down. Look up. Live."

[JOIN THE DIGITAL DETOX CHALLENGE](#)

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[Adapted from a South African public health advertisement, 2025]

QUESTION 5: MindfulSA Advertisement [2025]



QUESTION 6: Mental Health Awareness Poster [2026]

ENGLISH HOME LANGUAGE

PAPER 1

MARKING MEMORANDUM · 2026

Accept alternative correct answers. Credit well-reasoned responses demonstrating genuine understanding. Do not penalise poor language if the idea is correct (except where the question specifically tests language). Reward insight and evidence even if specific points differ from those listed.

www.rub yaitutor.com

SECTION A

COMPREHENSION [30]

QUESTIONS ON TEXT A

- 1.1** **Setting:** South Africa — from townships to suburbs; morning (before speaking to family). (1) (2)
Central concern: Smartphones have colonised the first and last moments of young people's days / youth dominated by screen notifications before real-world interaction. (1)
Award: 1 mark each. Accept paraphrases.
- 1.2** 'Sobering' means making one serious, clear-headed, or alarmed. (1) (2)
Reveals the writer has a **concerned / serious / alarmed** attitude — the data should shock the reader out of complacency. (1)
Award: Must identify meaning AND attitude.
- 1.3** Social media platforms trigger dopamine releases (likes, comments, shares) exploiting the human need for social validation. (1–2) (3)
Teenagers are at particular risk because their prefrontal cortices (governing impulse control and long-term thinking) are still developing — more susceptible to addictive feedback loops. (1)
Award: Up to 2 for exploitation mechanism (must mention dopamine for full 2); 1 for teen vulnerability reason.
- 1.4** Dr Khumalo means young people measure their real, imperfect lives against carefully selected, edited best moments others post online. (1–2) (3)
Creates an unfair comparison — the scroller sees an idealised artificial version of others' lives measured against their own messy reality. (1)
- 1.5** 'Social comparison injury': a persistent sense of inadequacy caused by measuring oneself against others online. (2) (3)
Made worse in South Africa because existing challenges — economic inequality, racial tension, unemployment — mean many young people lack support structures to process additional psychological pressure. (1)
- 1.6** **YES — effective:** Acknowledging benefits prevents the writer appearing one-sided, strengthening credibility/ethos. (2) (4)
The concession makes the final criticism ('something must give') more persuasive. (1)
Evidence: 'But critics respond that the same platforms which offer community also commodify vulnerability.' — swift return to critique shows the concession is purposeful. (1)
Award: Open-ended evaluation. Award marks for any reasoned position with evidence.

1.7 Overall tone is **concerned / critical / urgent**. (1 per valid tone word, max 2, must be justified) (3)

- **Concerned:** 'sobering'; 'unsustainable'.
- **Critical:** Platforms 'architecturally designed to exploit'; critique of policymakers.
- **Urgent:** 'Something must give'; 'the current situation is unsustainable.'

Award: 1 per valid tone word (max 2) + 1 for evidence. Must have BOTH for each mark.

1.8 **NOT fully objective** — clear position that social media is harmful and change is needed. (1) (3)

Evidence: 'Something must give — either platforms must be held accountable'; statistics selected to support concern; defenders given less space. (1)

PARTIALLY: paragraph 6 acknowledges benefits; some attempt at balance. But conclusion reveals normative stance. (1)

Award: 1 for clear position; 1 for explanation; 1 for textual evidence.

QUESTIONS ON TEXT B (CARTOON)

2.1 Award any TWO (1 mark each): (2)

- A teenager holding a phone and taking a selfie
- Bright colourful background with sunshine and flowers — idealised online world
- Floating hearts and stars — social media 'likes' / positive reactions
- Speech bubble reading '#PERFECT'
- Teen appears happy/smiling in Panel 1

Award: Must reference VISUAL DETAIL — not just 'teen on a phone'.

2.2 Humour/irony arises from the extreme contrast: Panel 1 shows a colourful idealised '#PERFECT' scene while Panel 2 shows the same teen in a grey, dull, messy room with '0 Likes'. (2) (2)

The gap between polished online image and mundane offline reality is so extreme it becomes comic — '#PERFECT' is ironic given what Panel 2 reveals.

2.3 **Message:** Social media creates a false, curated version of reality. Young people perform happiness online while real lives may be ordinary or difficult. (2) (3)

The two contrasting panels — bright/idealised vs grey/mundane — visually enforce the gap. (1)

The '#PERFECT' caption is ironic given Panel 2 — this verbal/visual tension carries the message. (1)

QUESTIONS ON BOTH TEXTS

3.1 **AGREEMENT:** Both texts agree social media creates a false version of reality. Text A states young people compare 'their unfiltered selves to everyone else's highlight reel'; the cartoon shows '#PERFECT' contrasted with dull reality. (2) (4)

DIFFERENCE: Text A takes a formal, analytical approach using statistics and expert opinion; the cartoon uses humour and visual contrast to deliver the same message more immediately and accessibly. (2)

Award: Must quote from BOTH texts. Difference must relate to approach/form, not content.

TOTAL SECTION A: 30

SECTION B

SUMMARY [10]

QUESTION 4.1 — SUMMARY

CONTENT POINTS — Award 1 mark each (max 7):

1. Teenagers need **meaningful connection** / genuine relationships.
2. They need **genuine challenge** — to be stretched and trusted with real responsibility.
3. They need the belief that they are **trusted** by adults.
4. They benefit from spaces for **honest conversation**.
5. They need the freedom to **fail and recover** — learning through mistakes.
6. Teenagers possess remarkable **creative energy**.
7. They have strong **moral sensitivity and a sense of justice**.
8. They demonstrate willingness to **act on principle at personal cost**.
9. History shows teenagers have **changed the world** (e.g. 1976 Soweto; 2019 climate strikes).

LANGUAGE AWARD — 3 marks:

MARKS	DESCRIPTOR
3	Fluent paragraph. Own words throughout. No copying. Within 90 words. Ideas flow logically.
2	Mostly own words. Minor copying OR slightly over limit. Generally fluent.
1	Significant copying OR poor construction OR well over limit.
0	No own words. Passage copied. No paragraph structure.

■ A learner giving MORE than 7 content points still receives maximum 7 for content. Word limit: if clearly over 90 words by significant margin, deduct 1 from Language. Count if in doubt.

TOTAL SECTION B: 10

SECTION C LANGUAGE STRUCTURES AND CONVENTIONS [30]

QUESTION 5 — ADVERTISEMENT [12]

- 5.1 The headline means that although teenagers spend significant time on phones, a screen cannot replace real life, real relationships, or genuine experiences. (1+1) (2)
Award: Must address MEANING. Award 1 for paraphrase + 1 for development/implication.
- 5.2 Phone with a cross (X) = universal symbol of prohibition / 'do not use this'. Communicates immediately without words that excessive phone use is discouraged. (1) (2)
Effective: works across language barriers; red X conveys urgency and warning, emotionally reinforcing the headline. (1)
- 5.3 Accept any ONE of: Statistics as emotional appeal / appeal to fear / direct address ('you') / tricolon slogan. Must name technique (1) + explain with quote (1). (2)
Award: Technique must be named OR clearly described, then explained with a quotation.
- 5.4 Large, bold, uppercase headline creates visual emphasis and commands attention immediately. (1) (2)
Bold creates authority and urgency; contrast between large headline and smaller body text creates hierarchy, guiding the reader's eye. (1)
- 5.5 **Target audience:** South African teenagers / youth / parents of teenagers. (1) (2)
Evidence (any TWO): statistics reference 'South African teenagers'; slogan uses short imperatives aimed at youth; references anxiety/depression/academic performance. (1)
Award: Must name audience AND give two evidence points.
- 5.6 Effective because (any 2): short punchy imperatives — memorable; three-part parallel structure creates rhythm; 'Live' as final word equates putting down phone with truly living; direct and personal without being preachy. (2) (2)

Sub-total: (12)

QUESTION 6 — POSTER / VISUAL TEXT [8]

- 6.1 **Purpose:** To raise awareness about mental health risks of excessive screen use; persuade young people to limit screen time. (1) (2)
Features (any TWO): warning statistics box / helpline number / 'What You Can Do' action steps / World Mental Health Day label. (1)
Award: Must identify purpose AND two supporting features.

6.2	Brain-and-phone image: technology interfering with / controlling the mind / mental health. (1) Effective: brain = identity/wellbeing; phone with chain = digital addiction; lightning bolt breaking chain = liberation — directly supports the message. (1)	(2)
6.3	Dark navy/blue background creates serious, ominous mood — reinforcing gravity of issue. (1) Gold text stands out, making key messages immediately visible; yellow helpline box creates urgent contrast. Colour scheme is authoritative without being alarmist. (1) <i>Award: Award marks for specific colour analysis tied to effect.</i>	(2)
6.4	FACT: '67% of South African teens check their phone within 5 minutes of waking up every morning.' (verifiable statistic) (1) OPINION: 'Seeking help is a sign of strength' (normative/value claim). (1) <i>Award: 1 for correctly identified + quoted fact, 1 for correctly identified + quoted opinion.</i>	(2)

Sub-total: (8)

QUESTION 7 — LANGUAGE STRUCTURES AND EDITING [18]

7.1	(a) changed — verb (past participle/past tense) (b) simply — adverb (c) pressing — adjective . Award 1 mark each.	(3)
7.2	Correct: ' Social media HAS changed... ' (1) — 'social media' treated as singular collective noun. (1) Also accept 'HAVE' with valid motivation: 'media' is plural of 'medium' — both defensible. <i>Award: Answer alone = 1 mark. Answer + motivation = 2 marks.</i>	(2)
7.3	Error [B]: they're → correct word: their (possessive pronoun)	(1)
7.4	'Although young people are not simply lazy or irresponsible, the platforms are designed to be addictive.' (Must begin as specified; meaning preserved; grammatically sound) <i>Award: 1 mark if beginning correct but sentence awkward; 2 marks for complete correct rewrite.</i>	(2)
7.5	Error [E]: there → correct: their . Corrected: '...failed to include digital literacy in their curriculums.'	(1)
7.6	Dr Khumalo told her colleague that they needed to teach young people how to use those tools wisely. (Changes: 'we'→'they'; 'need'→'needed'; 'these'→'those'; inverted commas removed) <i>Award: 1 for correct pronouns/tense; 1 for removing inverted commas and 'those'.</i>	(2)
7.7	Synonym for 'pressing': urgent / critical / crucial / serious / vital	(1)
7.8	Antonym of 'wisely': foolishly / unwisely / recklessly / irresponsibly	(1)

7.9	Prefix: ir- → irresponsible <i>Award: Only 'irresponsible' is correct.</i>	(1)
7.10	Redundancy: 'repeated' and 'again'. Corrected: 'She repeated the question because no one had answered.' <i>Award: Award 1 if redundancy identified AND correction provided.</i>	(1)
7.11	'To burn the midnight oil': to work or study very late into the night / to stay up late working hard.	(1)
7.12	Ambiguity: unclear whether Lerato or the teacher was in 'her room'. (1) Corrected (Lerato): 'From her room, Lerato watched the teacher correct the papers.' OR (Teacher): 'Lerato watched the teacher correct the papers in the teacher's room.' (1) <i>Award: 1 for identifying ambiguity; 1 for clear unambiguous rewrite.</i>	(2)

TOTAL SECTION C: 30

MARKS SUMMARY

Section	Content	Marks
A	Comprehension	30
B	Summary	10
C	Language Structures and Conventions	30
TOTAL		70

END OF MARKING MEMORANDUM